MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | DevOps / Platform Engineering Transition
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including two years focused largely on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and namespace-level ephemeral Kubernetes test environments for three product teams, improved average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and reduced flaky tests from 7% to below 1%, and is seeking a DevOps or platform engineering role.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm
Infrastructure and cloud: Kubernetes (namespace-level access at work; k3s personal homelab), Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic), AWS (learning: EC2 and S3 basics)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems and tools: Linux, Git, Argo CD, Traefik, cert-manager

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wrocław
2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing. Improved average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts deployed to a shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data, and created Grafana dashboards for flaky-test metrics using CI results and PostgreSQL. Wrote an internal guide to the CI system used in onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wrocław *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly runs.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Set up a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Added Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived environments for merge requests, deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Configured automatic teardown after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments to review features, and end-to-end tests run against them.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam booked for January 2027